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Report Name: Direct Versus Indirect Trade - Poland's Hidden Market for US Agricultural Exports

Country: Poland

Post: Warsaw

Report Category: Agricultural Situation, Beverages, Fishery Products, Tree Nuts, Wine, Livestock and Products, Oilseeds and Products

Prepared By: Anna Galica, Jolanta Figurska

Approved By: Levin Flake

Report Highlights:

U.S. Census Bureau's (USCB) bulk, intermediate, and consumer-oriented export data tracks U.S. food and agricultural trade shipped directly to Poland. However, it does not account for the substantial levels of the U.S. agricultural trade to Poland routed through Western European ports of entry. According to USCB, U.S. suppliers shipped \$354 million of U.S. food and agriculture to Poland in 2024. However, according to Poland's Central Statistical Office (CSO), which measures trade by country of origin and, therefore, reflects both direct and indirect trade, Poland sourced upwards of \$730 million of U.S. food and agriculture products in 2024. FAS/Warsaw encourages USDA cooperators and other U.S. food and agricultural exporters and stakeholders to look beyond USCB data and review different data sources when considering resource allocation and market development strategies for Poland.

The United States was Poland’s 17th largest supplier of food and agricultural products in 2024. U.S. goods flow into Poland either directly from the United States or are transshipped through other European Union (EU) ports of entry, mainly in the Netherlands and Germany. Because the U.S. Census Bureau's (USCB) data recorded in the USDA Global Agricultural Trade System ([GATS](#)) only reflects direct U.S. trade to Poland, it does not account for significant volumes of U.S. trade transshipped and routed through distributors in Rotterdam, Bremerhaven, and other large Western European port cities. As a result, FAS/Warsaw views Poland’s Central Statistical Office ([CSO](#)) data, which includes both direct and indirect trade, as a more accurate reflection of Polish demand for U.S. food and agricultural products.

According to CSO data, in 2024 Poland imported agricultural and related products valued at \$42.5 billion from all suppliers, which is six percent more than in 2023. The top five exporters to the Polish market were Germany, the Netherlands, Italy, Spain, and Ukraine, and the main imported commodities were soybean meal, seafood, petfood, food preparations, and pork. The United States was an important supplier in all those product categories.

According to CSO data, Polish importers sourced \$730 million worth of U.S. food and agricultural products in 2024 (See Table 1). In 2024, whiskies and wines, food preparations, tobacco, nuts and dried fruit, seafood, soybean meal, food additives, and animal feed preparations were the largest categories, and these categories accounted for over 77 percent of total Polish imports of U.S. food and agricultural products. According to USCB data, U.S. exports to Poland of agricultural and related products in 2024 was valued at \$354 million, with food preparations, nuts and dried fruit, whiskies, and animal feed preparations at the top of the list of exported products.

Table 1. U.S. Food and Agricultural Trade to Poland 2020-2024 (\$ million)

Source of Data	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024
USCB* (Direct U.S. exports to Poland)	163.7	208.1	266.9	375.6	354.4
CSO** (Direct and Indirect imports from the United States)	506.4	581.5	584.8	739.9	730.1
Difference (Indirect exports)	342.7	373.4	317.9	364.3	375.7
Percentage of indirect exports in total trade volume	68%	64%	54%	49%	51%

** Data on USCB trade published by Trade Data Monitor LLC (TDM) and by GATS*

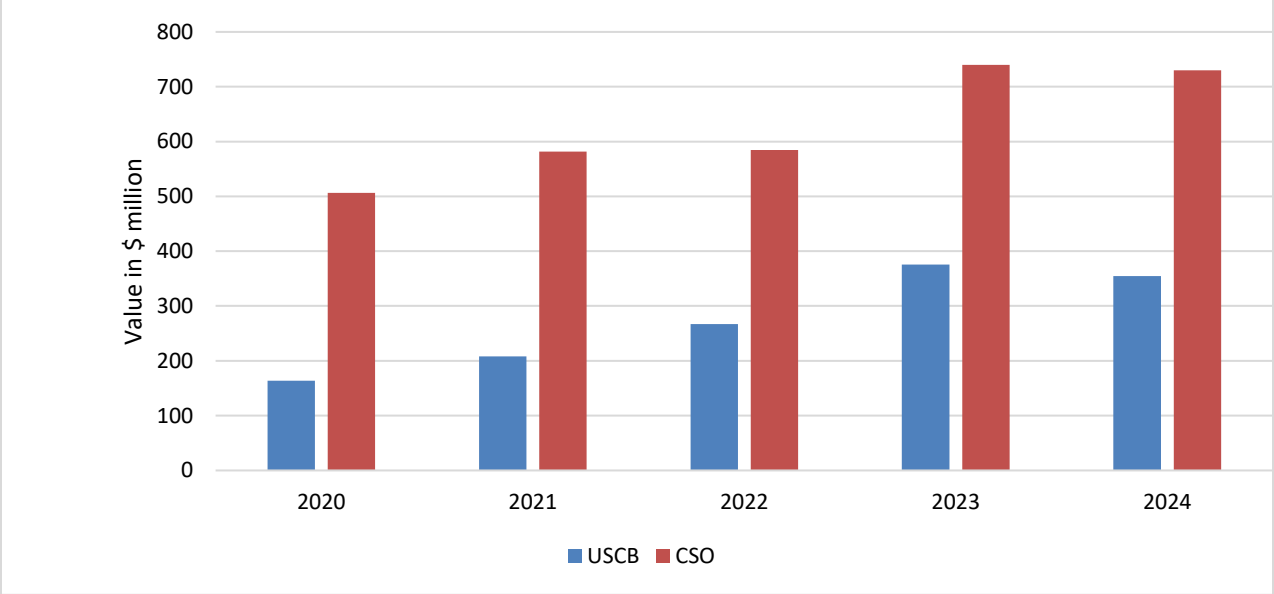
*** Data on CSO trade published by Trade Data Monitor LLC (TDM)*

Source: USCB and CSO

In 2024, both USCB and CSO data showed a slight decline in the U.S. trade in agricultural and related products to Poland compared to a record high in 2023. This decline was driven by lower imports of U.S. soybean meal substituted by supplies from major South American competitors. According to USCB data, 2024 U.S. exports of agricultural and related products to Poland decreased by six percent over 2023, while CSO reported a one-percent decrease in value of Polish imports from the United States in this period (See Chart 1). Nevertheless, the U.S. trade remained at high levels and Polish consumers increasingly value agricultural and related products of U.S. origin.

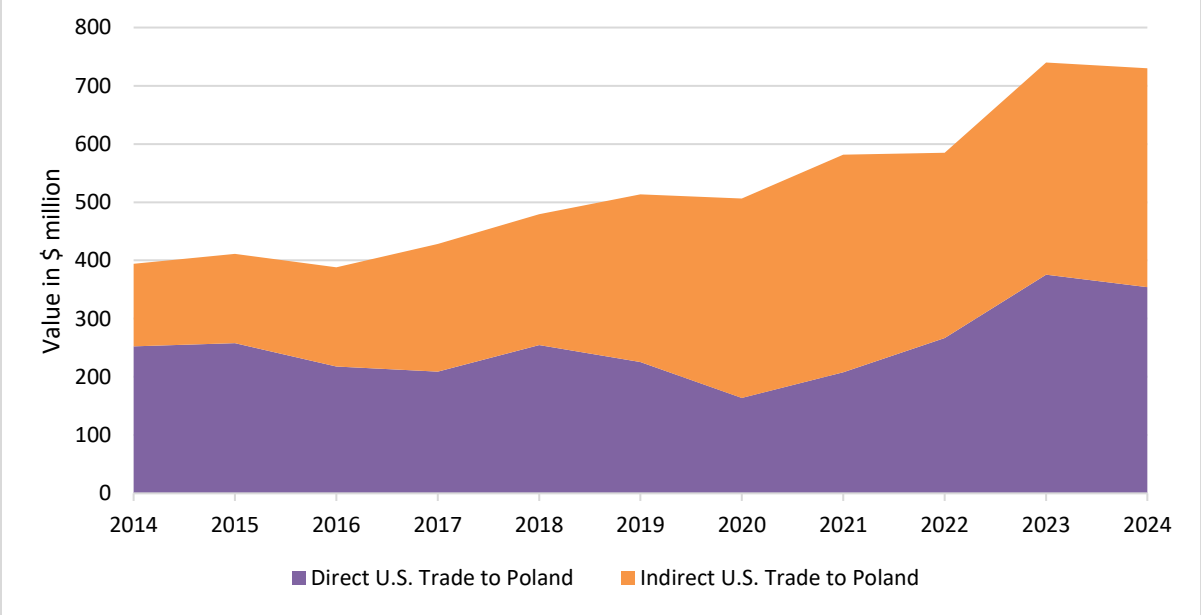
In recent years, the value of indirect U.S. agricultural trade to Poland has been relatively stable, with most of the increase in total trade accounted for in direct U.S. exports. As a result, since 2020 the share of total trade arriving indirectly has fallen from 68 percent in 2020 to about 51 percent last year.

Chart 1: USCB and CSO Data on U.S. Food and Agricultural Trade to Poland (\$ million)



Source: USCB and CSO

Chart 2: Historical U.S. Food and Agricultural Trade to Poland (\$ million)



Source: USCB and CSO

U.S. Food and Agricultural Trade to Poland by Category

Direct U.S. agricultural trade to Poland generally consists of products shipped as sea freight, including intermediate products like essential oils, feeds, and some bulk commodities like rice and pulses, and also some spirits. The trade data for these categories are captured by both USCB and CSO data. Indirect trade tends to be products that are shipped in smaller quantities, or that may require more flexible terms of trade than U.S. suppliers are able to provide. In other cases, Western European distributors can offer U.S. shippers sales volumes and/or payment terms that are more difficult for Polish importers (who may be smaller or new to the U.S. market) to match. Many U.S. exporters also find it more efficient to simply ship large volumes to well-established distribution hubs in Western Europe and rely on those channels to supply other EU markets. In addition, some Polish importers prefer to work through European distributors and find it more convenient for intermediaries to handle EU customs clearance for U.S. products. Also, for new-to-market products, some Polish importers prefer to purchase smaller volumes to test consumer demand and to build distribution channels before committing to longer term agreements and purchases. Finally, European distributors may incentivize Polish importers with favorable terms of payments or advertising, particularly if there are longstanding commercial relationships. Table 2 below shows USCB and CSO data for U.S. agricultural trade to Poland for different product groups.

Table 2. 2024 Direct and Indirect U.S. Agricultural, Food, and Fishery Trade to Poland (\$ 1,000)

Product	CSO (Direct and Indirect U.S. Trade to Poland) in 1,000 USD	USCB (Direct U.S. Exports to Poland) in 1,000 USD	Difference (Indirect) in 1,000 USD	% Share of Indirect Exports
Agricultural and Related Products	730,134	354,378	375,756	51%
Consumer Oriented Total	427,944	238,599	189,345	44%
Tree Nuts	123,958	59,585	64,373	52%
Distilled Spirits	102,225	93,752	8,473	8%
Food Preparations	87,112	49,971	37,141	43%
Wine and Related Products	29,721	1,191	28,530	96%
Processed Fruit	24,376	14,759	9,617	39%
Dog and Cat Food	15,642	2,196	13,446	86%
Processed Vegetables	13,471	4,019	9,452	70%
Dairy Products	9,064	3,738	5,326	59%
Meat Products NESOI	4,082	0	4,082	100%
Condiments and Sauces	4,010	3,341	669	17%
Bakery Goods, Cereals, and Pasta	2,885	507	2,378	82%
Other Consumer Oriented	2,832	2,358	474	17%
Confectionery	2,529	239	2,290	91%
Chocolate and Cocoa Products	1,674	15	1,659	99%
Non-Alcoholic Beverages (excluding juice)	1,219	1,019	200	16%
Beef and Beef Products	914	82	832	91%
Fresh Vegetables	909	6	903	99%

Fresh Fruit	403	0	403	100%
Beer	352	14	338	96%
Fruit and Vegetable Juices	275	945	-670	
Eggs and Products	188	0	188	100%
Nursery Products and Cut Flowers	89	23	66	74%
Poultry Meat and Products (excluding eggs)	12	0	12	100%
Pork and Pork Products	0	839	-839	
Intermediate Total	130,828	67,521	63,307	48%
Essential Oils	46,214	37,368	8,846	19%
Soybean Meal	28,607	0	28,607	100%
Other Feeds, Meals and Fodders	26,316	18,729	7,587	29%
Industrial alcohols and fatty acids	9,656	0	9,656	100%
Other Intermediate Products	6,834	4,356	2,478	36%
Dextrins, Peptones, and Proteins	6,806	2,672	4,134	61%
Planting Seeds	3,154	2,830	324	10%
Vegetable Oils (excluding soybean)	1,288	649	639	50%
Milled Grains and Products	1,132	58	1,074	95%
Sugar, Sweeteners, Beverage Bases	510	296	214	42%
Live Animals	283	551	-268	
Soybean Oil	18	0	18	100%
Oilseed meal/cake (excluding soybean)	11	0	11	100%
Distillers Grains	0	12	-12	
Agricultural Related Products	93,984	29,753	64,231	68%
Seafood Products	89,886	27,230	62,656	70%
Forest Products	4,074	2,523	1,551	38%
Biodiesel and Blends > B30	24	0	24	100%
Bulk Total	77,378	18,504	58,874	76%
Tobacco	61,996	11,127	50,869	82%
Other Bulk Commodities	9,076	4,498	4,578	50%
Pulses	3,449	1,711	1,738	50%
Rice	2,341	1,124	1,217	52%
Oilseeds (excluding soybean)	494	44	450	91%
Cotton	22	0	22	100%

Source: USCB and CSO

Indirect trade is significant for certain commodities. This concerns mainly tree nuts, wine, petfood, beef, and seafood. (See the Appendix for top 50 U.S. imported food and agricultural products most valued in 2024 by the World Customs Organization's Harmonized System (HS) code).

USCB showed \$25.9 million of U.S. pistachio in shell trade to Poland in 2024, while CSO valued U.S. pistachio trade to Poland at \$55.1 million. U.S. pistachios arrive in Poland mostly through German intermediaries, especially through German retail supply chains, as several large German retail chains are present throughout Poland.

For shelled almonds (fresh or dried), USCB data captured \$21.3 million of 2024 trade, while CSO data showed \$42.6 million of U.S. almonds. U.S. almonds were distributed to Poland through Spanish, German, and Dutch intermediaries.

USCB data indicated that 2024 U.S. wine and related products exports to Poland were valued at almost \$1.2 million. The 2024 CSO data cited \$29.7 million of U.S. wine. In 2024, most U.S. wine traded to Poland arrived through Germany, France, and the Netherlands, explaining the significant difference between USCB and CSO data.

In the case of whiskies, USCB data captures trade better, given that whiskies are often shipped via ocean freight directly to Poland and even distributed to other countries in the region from Poland.

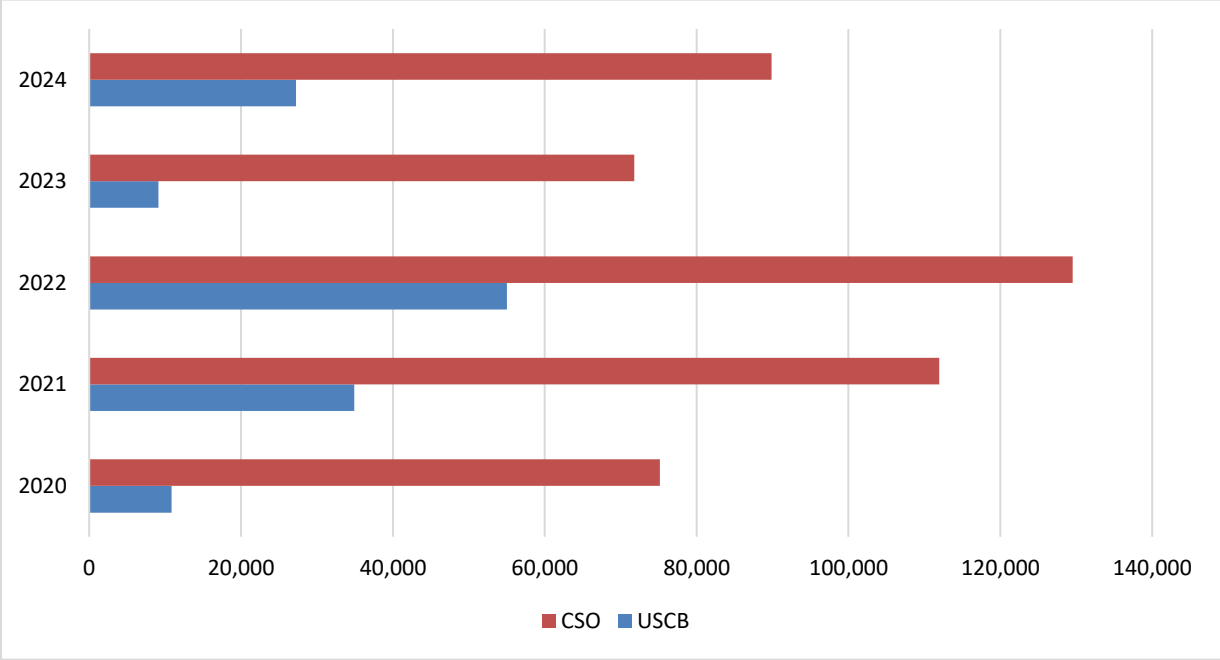
In the case of U.S. dog and cat food, USCB data indicated \$2.2 million, while CSO data showed \$15.6 million. A large proportion of U.S. petfood is distributed in Poland through German intermediaries, especially through German retail supply chains.

USCB data shows 2024 U.S. beef and beef product trade to Poland is valued at only \$0.1 million, while CSO data shows U.S. trade in 2024 valued at \$0.9 million. With the Polish market opening to high-end and alternative cuts of quality beef, U.S. products are generally purchased in smaller volumes through the European intermediaries.

According to CSO data, fish and seafood were among the major products traded to Poland in 2024. USCB data showed the total value of U.S. exports of fishery and seafood products at \$27.2 million, while CSO data reported \$89.9 million in 2024. While some U.S. seafood – particularly frozen sockeye salmon or flat fish – is shipped directly to Poland through the Port of Gdynia, most local seafood importers/processors prefer European distributors in the Netherlands and Germany. For example, USCB data in 2024 showed \$303,000 worth of trade of U.S. Alaska pollock (HS code 030475) to Poland, while CSO data showed that Alaskan pollock trade reached \$31.9 million. (Alaska pollock fillets arrive in Poland mainly through the Netherlands and Germany).

Poland is the number one salmon processor in the world and imports almost 95 percent of the seafood it processes. Norway, Russia, Sweden, Iceland, Germany, China, and the United States were Poland's main suppliers of seafood and products in 2024. U.S. seafood imports to Poland were at record high levels in 2022. After a decline in 2023 caused by competition from lower priced products, trade rebounded in 2024 as Polish processors came back to high quality U.S. suppliers. Regardless of trade fluctuations, the value of U.S. exports of seafood to Poland has regularly been undercounted. (See Chart 3).

Chart 3. U.S. Seafood Trade to Poland (\$ 1,000)



Source: USCB and CSO

The differences in specific products can be traced by HS codes. Because a majority of the direct and indirect U.S. trade is covered by HS code 03 (fish and crustaceans, molluscs, and other aquatic invertebrates), the code can be used to illustrate how CSO and USCB capture U.S. exports of fish and fishery products to Poland. The comparison indicates that over 70 percent of U.S. exports were underestimated by USCB data in 2024 (See Table 3).

Table 3. U.S. Fish and Seafood Traded to Poland 2020-2024 (\$ 1,000)

HS Code	Description	Data Source	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024
03	fish and crustaceans, molluscs, and other aquatic invertebrates	CSO	74,950	111,693	129,426	71,728	89,736
		USCB	10,449	34,568	53,081	7,135	25,397
0301	fish, live	CSO	22	12	26	49	51
		USCB	15	22	29	31	51
0302	fish, fresh or chilled, excluding fish fillets and other fish meat without bones; fish livers and roes, fresh or chilled	CSO	1	96	0	235	0
		USCB	0	0	0	0	85
0303	fish, frozen, excluding fish fillets and other fish meat without bones; fish livers and roes, frozen	CSO	30,374	62,582	69,291	33,112	40,089
		USCB	6,865	32,486	48,750	4,156	24,173
0304	fish fillets and other fish meat (whether or not minced), fresh, chilled or frozen	CSO	44,402	48,771	59,379	37,717	49,272
		USCB	3,567	2,059	4,303	2,930	1,089

0305	fish, dried, salted or in brine; smoked fish; fish meal fit for human consumption	CSO	44	88	645	523	244
		USCB	0	0	0	0	0
0306	crustaceans, live fresh chilled frozen dried etc.; smoked; in shell, cooked by steam or boiling water; flours, meals and pellets for human consumption	CSO	21	17	50	45	48
		USCB	0	0	0	10	0
0307	molluscs, live, fresh, chilled, frozen, dried, salted or in brine; smoked; flours, meals and pellets, fit for human consumption	CSO	80	122	30	40	24
		USCB	0	0	0	8	0
0308	aquatic invertebrates other than crustaceans and molluscs, live, fresh, chilled, frozen, dried, salted/ in brine; smoked; edible flours, meals and pellets	CSO	6	6	5	8	7
		USCB	3	0	0	0	0

Source: USCB and CSO

As with many other products, seafood deliveries get customs cleared in Western Europe and Poland is not recorded as their final destination. Therefore, when analyzing the importance of the Polish market, Polish import data should be used to fully reflect the current market situation.

Appendix

Top 50 U.S. Food and Agricultural Products Imported in 2024, by HS Code (\$ 1,000)

No.	HS Code	Code Description	Direct and Indirect U.S. Trade to Poland (CSO)	Direct U.S. Exports to Poland (USCB)	Indirect U.S. Trade to Poland (Difference)	% Share of Indirect Exports
	TOTAL	Agricultural and Related Products	730,134	354,378	375,756	51%
1	220830	Whiskies	91,293	93,160	-1,867	
2	210690	Food Preparations Nesoi	87,041	50,503	36,537	42%
3	240120	Tobacco, Partly Or Wholly Stemmed/Stripped	59,298	10,470	48,828	82%
4	080251	Pistachios, In Shell, Fresh Or Dried	55,197	25,915	29,281	53%
5	080212	Almonds, Fresh Or Dried, Shelled	42,558	21,299	21,259	50%
6	030475	Alaska Pollock (Theragra chalcogramma)	31,891	303	31,588	99%
7	230400	Soybean Oilcake And Other Solid Residues Resulting From The Extraction Of Soy Bean Oil, Whether Or Not Ground Or In The Form Of Pellets	28,607	0	28,607	100%
8	330210	Mixtures Of Odoriferous Substances And Mixtures (Including Alcoholic Solutions) With A Basis Of These Substances Used In The Food Or Drink Industries	28,054	37,261	-9,207	
9	220421	Wine Of Fresh Grapes (Other Than Sparkling Wine) And Grape Must With Fermentation Prevented, Etc. By Adding Alcohol, Containers Of Not Over 2 Liters	24,049	975	23,074	96%
10	230990	Animal Feed Preparations (Mixed Feeds, Etc.), Other Than Dog Or Cat Food Put Up For Retail Sale	23,997	18,729	5,269	22%
11	030311	Sockeye Salmon (Red Salmon) (Oncorhynchus Nerka), Frozen	23,253	15,179	8,074	35%
12	230910	Dog And Cat Food, Put Up For Retail Sale	15,642	2,196	13,446	86%
13	200893	Cranberries (Vaccinium macrocarpon, Vaccinium oxycoccos); lingonberries	14,986	7,055	7,931	53%

		(Vaccinium vitisidaea)				
14	330129	Essential Oils, Nesoi	14,063	35	14,027	100%
15	080252	Pistachios, Shelled, Fresh Or Dried	13,201	1,790	11,411	86%
16	030312	Pacific Salmon (Oncorhynchus Gorbusha, Keta, Tschawytscha, Kisutch, Masou And Rhodurus), Frozen, Nesoi	10,710	3,740	6,971	65%
17	382370	Industrial Fatty Alcohols	8,477	0	8,477	100%
18	200290	Tomatoes, Other Than Whole Or In Pieces (Including Paste And Puree), Prepared Or Preserved Otherwise Than By Vinegar Or Acetic Acid	8,095	3,201	4,894	60%
19	220840	Rum And Tafia	7,892	0	7,892	100%
20	080299	Nuts, fresh or dried, whether or not shelled or peeled (excl. coconuts, Brazil nuts, cashew nuts, almonds, hazelnuts, filberts, walnuts, chestnuts, pistachios, macadamia nuts, kola nuts, areca nuts and pine nuts)	5,645	2,062	3,584	63%
21	030495	Fish of the families Bregmacerotidae, Eulichthyidae, Gadidae, Macrouridae, Melanonidae, Merlucciidae, Moridae and Muraenolepididae, other than Alaska Pollock (Theragra chalcogramma)	5,139	0	5,139	100%
22	030339	Flat Fish, Nesoi, Excluding Fillets, Livers And Roes, Frozen	5,090	4,305	785	15%
23	081320	Prunes, Dried	4,878	4,679	199	4%
24	030481	Pacific Salmon (Oncorhynchus Nerka, Gorbusha, Keta, Etc.), Atlantic Salmon (Salmo Salar) And Danube Salmon (Hucho Hucho) Fillets, Frozen	4,871	318	4,553	93%
25	080232	Walnuts, Fresh Or Dried, Shelled	4,576	3,294	1,281	28%
26	120242	Peanuts, Shelled, Whether Or Not Broken Other Than Seed	4,311	1,147	3,164	73%
27	050400	Animal Guts, Bladders And Stomachs (Other Than Fish), Whole And Pieces Thereof, Fresh, Chilled, Frozen, Salted, In Brine, Dried Or Smoked	4,010	839	3,171	79%
28	071420	Sweet Potatoes, Fresh Or Dried, Whether Or Not Sliced Or In The Form Of Pellets	3,897	0	3,897	100%

29	210610	Protein Concentrates And Textured Protein Substances	3,495	2,327	1,168	33%
30	210390	Sauces And Preparations Therefor, Nesoi; Mixed Condiments And Mixed Seasonings	3,472	3,210	262	8%
31	051110	Bovine Semen	3,460	3,090	371	11%
32	190190	Malt Extract; Food Products Of Flour, Meal, Etc. With Cocoa (If Any) Under 40% And Milk Or Cream Products With Cocoa (If Any) Under 50%, Nesoi	3,416	3,035	382	11%
33	350220	Milk Albumin, Including Concentrates Of Two Or More Whey Proteins	3,361	208	3,153	94%
34	071333	Kidney Beans, Including White Pea Beans (Phaseolus Vulgaris), Dried Shelled, Including Seed	2,795	1,521	1,274	46%
35	030474	Hake (Merluccius Spp., Urophycis Spp.) Fillets, Frozen	2,734	129	2,605	95%
36	30494	Alaska Pollock (Theragra chalcogramma)	2,687	0	2,687	100%
37	120991	Vegetable Seeds For Sowing	2,638	1,363	1,274	48%
38	200819	Nuts (Other Than Peanuts (Ground-Nuts)), And Other Seeds, Including Mixtures, Prepared Or Preserved, Nesoi	2,631	153	2,478	94%
39	240130	Tobacco Refuse (Waste)	2,618	657	1,962	75%
40	220600	Fermented Beverages, Nesoi (Incl Cider, Perry & Mead); Mixtures Of Fermented Beverages & Mixtures Of Fermented Beverages & Non-Alcohol Beverage Nesoi	2,548	0	2,548	100%
41	170490	Sugar Confectionary (Including White Chocolate), Not Containing Cocoa, Nesoi	2,523	50	2,473	98%
42	100630	Rice, Semi-Milled Or Wholly Milled, Whether Or Not Polished Or Glazed	2,335	1,124	1,211	52%
43	350110	Casein	2,096	0	2,096	100%
44	081190	Fruit, Nesoi, And Nuts, Uncooked Or Cooked By Steaming Or Boiling In Water, Whether Or Not Containing Added Sweetening, Frozen	1,995	2,973	-978	
45	350510	Dextrins And Other Modified	1,991	287	1,703	86%

		Starches				
46	120241	Peanuts, In Shell, Other Than Seed	1,990	3,219	-1,228	
47	230310	Residues Of Starch Manufacture And Similar Residues, Whether Or Not In The Form Of Pellets	1,934	0	1,934	100%
48	330113	Essential Citrus Fruit Oils Of Lemon	1,406	3	1,403	100%
49	350400	Peptones And Derivatives; Other Proteins And Derivatives, Nesoi; Hide Powder, Chromed Or Not	1,320	57	1,263	96%
50	220870	Liqueurs And Cordials	1,282	49	1,233	96%

Source: USCB and CSO

Attachments:

No Attachments.